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20 Claude Code Commands That Make Your Life Easier (Most People Don't Know Them)



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If you only use Claude Code like “ChatGPT in a terminal,” you’re missing 80% of the magic.

I’ve compiled the 20 most useful commands for beginners and non-programmers, grouped into four categories based on their capabilities.

The best part? You don’t need to be a programmer to use any of this.

Stop, Rewind, and Split Your Thoughts

1. Esc — Stop it right now

Claude doing something weird? Hit `Esc` It stops. No drama.

The conversation history is preserved; only the current task is stopped.

2. Double-tap `Esc` or `/rewind` — Undo with style

You can rewind the code, the conversation, or both. It even gives you a cute menu.

1. Restore `code` and conversation — Roll back both the `code` and conversation
2. Restore conversation — Roll back only the conversation
3. Restore `code` — Roll back only the `code`, not the conversation

- 4. Summarize **from** here – Summarize starting **from** this point
- 5. Never mind – Cancel

3. `/btw` — Ask side questions without messing up the main task

This one is useful. You can ask:

```
/btw where is the test file again
```

Claude allows you to ask quick, side questions without interrupting the main task, cluttering conversation history

Key point: It uses almost no tokens because it reuses the current prompt cache.

4. `/branch` — Create a parallel universe

Want to try two different ideas? Branch the conversation. Each version grows separately. Pick the winner later.

Keep Your Conversations Clean and Organized

5. `/compact` — Shrink the history, not erase.

It turns long chat history into one short summary so the context window doesn't explode. The summary keeps: **main storyline + key technical points + errors & fixes.**

6. `/clear` — Fresh start

Wipe everything. New topic, new life.

7. `/export` — export as Markdown

If you've been discussing an architecture for half an hour and don't want to lose it, `/export` saves the entire conversation as a `.md` file (Markdown). The file path looks like:

```
~/projects/XXX/claude-session-YYYY-MM-DD-HH-MM.md
```

8. `/resume` — Bring back old chats

Search by keyword. Very handy for long projects.

9. `"claude -c"` — Continue yesterday's chat

Claude command. You're back where you left off.

10. `"claude -r"` — Pick a specific topic

Claude command. Shows all your past sessions. Choose the one you want to resume.

11. `/remote-control` (or `/rc`) — Move the session to your phone

Claude keeps running on your computer. Your phone becomes a remote control. Perfect when you need to leave your desk.

Let Claude Help You Work Smarter

12. `/model <opusplan>` — Think slow, code fast

Claude uses Opus for planning (smart) and Sonnet for coding (fast). You get the best of both.

13. `/simplify` — Three agents review your code

Claude runs three reviewers at once:

- Architecture/Code Reuse Review
- Code Quality Review
- Efficiency Review.

They give you a combined report.

14. `/insights` — Your monthly usage report

Claude generates a local HTML page (`~/.claude/usage-data/report.html`) showing:

- your habits
- your mistakes
- features you never use
- suggestions for your CLAUDE.md

It's like a fitness tracker, but for your workflow.

15. `/loop` — Run tasks on a schedule

Allows you to schedule recurring tasks or set one-time reminders that run automatically within your current

session.

```
/loop 15m check the deploy  
/loop in 20m remind me to push this branch
```

Default: To prevent runaway API costs, recurring tasks automatically expire 3 to 7 days after creation.

Advanced Usage: loop.md

You can customize the default maintenance behavior by creating a `.claude/loop.md` file in your project directory. If this file exists, a bare `/loop` command will execute the instructions found inside instead of the standard built-in prompt.

Keyboard Shortcuts That Save Your Fingers

16. `Ctrl+V` — Paste screenshots directly

No saving files. Just paste the screenshot into Claude.

17. `Ctrl+J` or `Option+Enter` (Mac) — New line without sending

Write multi-line prompts safely.

18. `Ctrl+R` — Search your old prompts

Find anything you typed before. It's like your own

prompt library.

19. `Ctrl+U` — Clear the whole line

One key. Everything gone. Very satisfying.

20. `/skills [name]` — Load custom skills

Use project-specific tools. Run `/skills` alone to see what's available.

Cheat Sheet (Simple & Useful)

- `Esc` - Stop the current task immediately.
- `/rewind` - Roll back the code, the chat, or both.
- `/btw` — Ask a side question without messing up the main conversation.
- `/branch` — Create a new “parallel universe” to explore another idea.
- `/compact` — Shrink long chat history into a short summary.
- `/clear` — Erase all history and start fresh.
- `/export` — Save the whole conversation as a text file.
- `/resume` — Bring back past sessions with search support. (CLI also supports this: `claude --resume` or `claude -r`)
- (CLI only: `claude -c`) — Continue the most recent

session instantly.

- `/remote-control` — Move your session to your phone while the code keeps running on your computer.
- `/model <opusplan >` — Plan with Opus (smart), execute with Sonnet (fast).
- `/simplify` — Run three parallel agents to review your code.
- `/insights` — Generate a monthly usage report about your habits.
- `/loop` — Run a task repeatedly on a schedule.
- `Ctrl+V` — Paste screenshots directly into Claude.
- `Ctrl+J` / `Option+Enter` (Mac) — Add a new line without sending the message.
- `Ctrl+R` — Search your old prompts like a built-in library.
- `Ctrl+U` — Clear the entire input line in one go.
- `/skills [name]` — Load a custom skill for your project.

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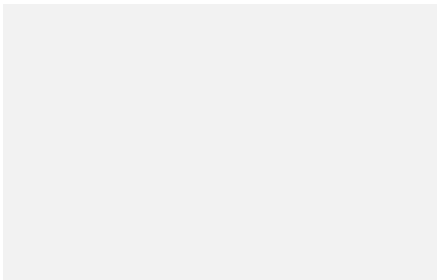
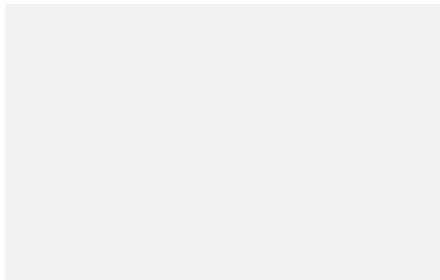
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